

without a jury the inquisition shall be under the hand of the coroner alone.

(3) Where an inquest or any part of an inquest is held without a jury anything done at the inquest or at that part of the inquest by or before the coroner alone shall be as validly done as if it had been done by or before the coroner and a jury.

8.—(1) This Act may be cited as the Juries Act, 1918.

(2) This Act shall not extend to Scotland or Ireland.

(3) This Act shall have effect during the continuance of the present war and for a period of six months thereafter.

Short title,
extent, and
duration.

CHAPTER 24.

An Act to enable Companies and other bodies to give Financial Assistance to Flax Companies.

[30th July 1918.]

WHEREAS the extension of the cultivation of flax and the provision of increased supplies thereof is essential for various purposes of national importance, including purposes connected with the present war, and it is expedient that the giving of financial assistance to companies concerned in such cultivation and provision should be facilitated :

Be it therefore enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows :

1. Any company, association or body of persons, notwithstanding anything contained in any Act, Order or instrument, by or under which it is constituted or regulated, shall, subject to the consent of the Board of Trade, have power, if so determined by a resolution passed at a general meeting of the company, association, or body of persons—

Power for
companies &c.
to give finan-
cial assistance
to flax com-
panies and to
borrow for
that purpose.

(i) during the continuance of the present war, and a period of twelve months thereafter—

(a) to subscribe for, take, purchase, or otherwise acquire, hold, sell, and dispose of shares, stock, or other securities of any limited liability company formed or to be formed, and having for its principal object the cultivation of flax or the provision of supplies thereof, or the promotion of such cultivation or provision ;

(b) to lend money to any such company ;

(c) to guarantee, or join with others in guaranteeing, any debts, obligations, or liabilities, present or future, of any such company ;

(d) to give financial assistance in any other form to any such company ;

(e) to apply any of their funds or, with the consent of the Treasury, to borrow for the purpose of any such acquisition of shares, stock, or other securities, loan of money, guarantee, or financial assistance as aforesaid : Provided always that the power to borrow money conferred by this Act shall not operate so as to increase the total amount of money which such company, association, or body of persons is authorised to borrow ; and

(ii) after the expiration of the said period of twelve months to hold, sell, or dispose of any such shares, stock, or other securities, and continue or renew any such loan guarantee, or other financial assistance, or any such borrowing as aforesaid.

Short title.

2. This Act may be cited as the Flax Companies (Financial Assistance) Act, 1918.

CHAPTER 25.

An Act to make further provision for raising Money for the present War, and to amend the War Loan (Supplemental Provisions) Act, 1915. [30th July 1918.]

Most Gracious Sovereign,

WE, Your Majesty's most dutiful and loyal subjects, the Commons of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Ireland in Parliament assembled, towards making good the supply which we have cheerfully granted to Your Majesty in this session of Parliament, have resolved to grant unto Your Majesty the sums hereinafter mentioned ; and do therefore most humbly beseech Your Majesty that it may be enacted, and be it enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows :

Issue of new war loan.

1.—(1) Any money required for the raising of any supply granted to His Majesty for the service of the year ending the thirty-first day of March nineteen hundred and nineteen, and, in addition, of a sum not exceeding two hundred and fifty million pounds, or for the raising of any sum required for cancelling securities or Treasury bills under the powers of this Act, may be raised in such manner as the Treasury think fit, and for that purpose they may create and issue any securities by means of which any public loan has been raised or may be